

DIRECTION

1. Passage anchor

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a nudge in the right **direction**, and that made all the difference.”

Passage meaning

direction = the general course in which someone's life, choices, development, or actions are moving

方向；發展方向；道路

Here, **the right direction** is figurative.

It means:

= a beneficial, appropriate, or constructive course of development

正確的方向；適合的發展方向

Mrs. Chan did not decide the speaker's whole life. She gave the speaker a small push toward a healthier way of thinking and communicating.

Practice

1. Her advice pushed me in a better **direction**.

她的建議把我推向一個更好的**方向**。

2. I was still unsure of my future, but at least I was moving in the right **direction**.

我對未來仍然不確定，但至少我正朝著正確的**方向**前進。

Core meanings of DIRECTION

2. direction — the way toward which someone or something moves or faces

= the course or line along which someone or something moves, points, or faces

方向；方位

Examples

1. Which **direction** are we going?

我們正往哪個**方向**走？

2. The wind changed **direction**.

風改變了**方向**。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. in the direction of something

= toward a particular place or point

朝.....方向；向著.....

Examples

1. She walked **in the direction of the station**.
她朝車站的**方向**走去。
2. The car disappeared **in the direction of the city centre**.
那輛車朝市中心的**方向**消失了。

4. from the direction of something

= coming from a particular side or place

從.....方向

Examples

1. I heard a noise **from the direction of the kitchen**.
我聽到聲音從廚房的**方向**傳來。
2. Smoke was coming **from the direction of the hills**.
煙從山丘的**方向**飄來。

Compass / spatial orientation

5. direction — compass point or orientation

= a position such as north, south, east, or west

方位；方向

Examples

1. The compass shows the correct **direction**.
指南針顯示正確的**方向**。

2. We were travelling in a northerly ****direction****.
我們正朝北方****前進****。

6. change direction

= begin moving, pointing, or developing another way
****改變方向；轉向****

Examples

1. The cyclist suddenly ****changed direction****.
騎腳踏車的人突然****改變方向****。

2. The storm ****changed direction**** overnight.
暴風雨在夜間****轉向了****。

Can be literal or figurative.

Route / course

7. direction — general route or course

= the general way in which something proceeds
****方向；路線****

Examples

1. The road continues in the same ****direction****.
這條路繼續朝相同的****方向****延伸。

2. We seem to be heading in the wrong ****direction****.
我們好像正在往錯的****方向****走。

Figurative development

8. direction — course of development

= the way a person, organization, idea, project, or situation is developing
****發展方向；走向****

This is the passage family.

Examples

1. The project is moving in a promising **direction**.
這個專案正朝著有希望的**方向**發展。
2. Her career began to move in a new **direction**.
她的職涯開始朝新的**方向**發展。

9. the right direction

= a correct, useful, beneficial, or appropriate course
正確方向；合適的發展方向

Examples

1. This is a step in the **right direction**.
這是朝**正確方向**邁出的一步。
2. The new policy moves things in the **right direction**.
新政策讓事情朝**正確方向**發展。

This is the exact passage sense.

10. the wrong direction

= an unsuitable, harmful, or mistaken course
錯誤方向；不理想的走向

Examples

1. The discussion was moving in the **wrong direction**.
討論正朝著**錯誤的方向**發展。
2. I realized my career was heading in the **wrong direction**.
我意識到自己的職涯正走向**不適合我的方向**。

11. move / head in a particular direction

= develop toward a particular state or outcome

****朝某個方向發展****

Examples

1. The industry is moving in a more sustainable ****direction****.

這個產業正朝更永續的****方向****發展。

2. The conversation headed in an unexpected ****direction****.

談話朝一個意想不到的****方向****發展。

Guidance / leadership

12. direction — guidance or leadership

= guidance about what should be done or how something should develop

****指導；引導；領導****

Examples

1. The team needs clearer ****direction****.

團隊需要更明確的****方向與指導****。

2. Without strong ****direction****, the project lost focus.

缺乏有力的****引導****後，專案失去了焦點。

This is distinct from physical orientation.

13. provide direction

= give guidance or indicate how to proceed

****提供方向；給予指導****

Examples

1. A good mentor can ****provide direction**** without controlling every decision.

好導師可以****提供方向****，而不是控制每一個決定。

2. The manager gave the team clear ****direction****.

經理給了團隊清楚的****指導****。

Very relevant to the passage's mentor theme.

14. under someone's direction

= being guided, supervised, or controlled by someone

****在某人的指導 / 領導下****

Examples

1. The project was completed ****under her direction****.

專案在她的****指導下****完成。

2. The orchestra performed ****under the direction of**** a guest conductor.

樂團在客席指揮的****指揮下****演出。

Instructions

15. directions — instructions telling someone how to reach a place

Plural ****directions**** can mean:

= instructions describing the route to a destination

****路線指示；怎麼走的指示****

Examples

1. Can you give me ****directions to the station****?

你可以告訴我****怎麼走到車站****嗎？

2. I followed her ****directions**** and found the hotel easily.

我跟著她的****路線指示****，很快就找到了飯店。

This is a major distinct plural use.

16. ask for directions

= ask someone to explain how to reach a place

****問路****

Examples

1. We stopped to **ask for directions**.

我們停下來**問路**。

2. He was too shy to **ask for directions**.

他太害羞，不敢**問路**。

17. give directions

= tell someone how to reach a place

指路；告訴某人路線

Examples

1. A local resident **gave us directions**.

一位當地居民**為我們指路**。

2. Can you **give me directions to the museum**?

你能告訴我**怎麼去博物館**嗎？

Instructions for doing something

18. directions — instructions explaining how to do or use something

= written or spoken instructions for carrying out a task

說明；操作指示；使用方法

Examples

1. Read the **directions** carefully before using the product.

使用產品前仔細閱讀**說明**。

2. Follow the **directions on the package**.

按照包裝上的**使用說明**操作。

Especially common in American English.

British English often prefers **instructions** in many such contexts.

19. follow directions

= do what instructions tell you to do

****按照指示；遵循說明****

Examples

1. Please ****follow the directions**** carefully.

請仔細****按照指示操作****。

2. The experiment works if you ****follow the directions****.

只要你****按照說明****做，實驗就會成功。

Control / management

20. direction — control over how work is carried out

= management, supervision, or control of an activity

****管理；指揮；指導****

Examples

1. The work was carried out under professional ****direction****.

這項工作是在專業****指導****下完成的。

2. She took over the ****direction of the project****.

她接手了專案的****管理與主導工作****。

Formal.

Theatre / film

21. direction — directing a film, play, etc.

= the work of guiding actors and controlling the artistic interpretation of a production

****導演；導演工作****

Examples

1. The film won an award for best ****direction****.

這部電影獲得最佳****導演****獎。

2. The play benefited from strong ****direction****.

這齣戲因出色的**導演工作**而更加成功。

A genuinely distinct arts sense.

22. stage direction

= instruction in a script telling actors how to move, speak, or behave

舞台指示；舞台說明

Examples

1. The actor ignored the **stage direction**.
那名演員沒有按照**舞台指示**。
2. The script includes detailed **stage directions**.
劇本包含詳細的**舞台說明**。

23. artistic direction

= guidance and control over the artistic style or creative vision of a project

藝術指導；創意方向

Examples

1. She was responsible for the project's **artistic direction**.
她負責專案的**藝術方向**。
2. The campaign has a clear visual **direction**.
這個宣傳活動有清楚的視覺**創意方向**。

General tendency / trend

24. direction — tendency or trend

= the general way in which something is changing

趨勢；走向

Examples

1. It is difficult to predict the **direction of the market**.

很難預測市場的**走向**。

2. The data suggest a clear **direction of change**.

數據顯示出明確的變化**趨勢**。

Academic / conceptual orientation

25. direction of research / discussion

= the particular line or focus that research or discussion takes

研究方向；討論方向

Examples

1. The findings suggest a new **direction for research**.

研究結果指出了一個新的**研究方向**。

2. Her question changed the **direction of the discussion**.

她的問題改變了討論的**方向**。

Related forms

26. direct — verb: guide or control

= control, guide, or manage someone or something

指導；指揮；管理

Examples

1. She **directed the team** during the project.

她在專案期間**指導團隊**。

2. The officer **directed traffic**.

那名警員**指揮交通**。

27. direct — verb: point or send somewhere

= cause someone or something to go toward a particular place

指引；引導；把.....導向

Examples

1. Staff ****directed visitors to the main entrance****.
工作人員****引導訪客前往主入口****。
2. Please ****direct your questions to the manager****.
請把問題****交由 / 向經理提出****。

28. direct — adjective: straight / without intermediate steps

= going straight from one place, person, or point to another
****直接的 ; 直達的****

Examples

1. Is there a ****direct train**** to the airport?
有沒有到機場的****直達列車****？
2. We need ****direct communication**** between the two teams.
我們需要兩個團隊之間的****直接溝通****。

29. directly

Major useful meanings include:

A. in a straight line / without an intermediary

****直接地****

She spoke ****directly to the manager****.
她****直接****跟經理說。

B. exactly

****正好 ; 直接****

The hotel is ****directly opposite the station****.
飯店****正好在車站對面****。

C. immediately, in some varieties/contexts

****立刻 ; 馬上****

I'll come **directly**.

我會**立刻**過來。

The last use is less universal in modern everyday English.

30. director

= person who directs an organization, department, film, play, etc.

主管；董事；導演

Examples

1. She is the **director** of the department.

她是部門**主管**。

2. The film **director** spoke after the screening.

電影**導演**在放映後發言。

Context determines the Chinese.

31. directional

= relating to direction or designed to work in a particular direction

方向的；指向性的

Examples

1. The device uses a **directional microphone**.

這個裝置使用**指向性麥克風**。

2. The sign provides **directional information**.

這個標誌提供**方向指引資訊**。

32. redirect

= direct something to a different place, person, purpose, or course

重新導向；轉向

Examples

1. The website **redirected me to another page**.

網站把我**重新導向另一個頁面**。

2. She learned to **redirect her attention** toward what she could control.

她學會把注意力**重新轉向**自己能控制的事情。

High-value expressions

33. in the right direction

= toward an appropriate, desirable, or successful outcome

朝正確方向

Examples

1. The changes are moving us **in the right direction**.

這些改變正帶著我們**朝正確方向前進**。

2. Asking for feedback was a move **in the right direction**.

尋求回饋是朝**正確方向**邁進的一步。

Exact passage family.

34. a step in the right direction

= an action that improves a situation, although it may not solve everything

朝正確方向邁出的一步；好的開始

Examples

1. The new rule is **a step in the right direction**.

新規定是**朝正確方向邁出的一步**。

2. Admitting the problem was **a step in the right direction**.

承認問題是一個**好的開始**。

Very common idiom.

35. point someone in the right direction

= give enough guidance to help someone proceed correctly

****給某人指明方向；提供正確指引****

Examples

1. I didn't know the answer, but she ****pointed me in the right direction****.

我不知道答案，但她****給我指明了正確方向****。

2. A mentor can ****point you in the right direction**** without making every decision for you.

導師可以****為你指明方向****，而不必替你作每個決定。

Very relevant to the passage.

36. go in a different direction

= choose a different plan, style, approach, or development

****朝不同方向發展；改走另一條路****

Examples

1. We decided to ****go in a different direction**** with the design.

我們決定讓設計****朝不同方向發展****。

2. Her career eventually ****went in a completely different direction****.

她的職涯最後****走向了完全不同的方向****。

37. lose your sense of direction

A. literally become unsure which way to go

****失去方向感；迷路****

B. figuratively lose clarity about goals or purpose

****失去人生 / 發展方向****

Examples

1. I easily ****lose my sense of direction**** in unfamiliar cities.

我在陌生城市很容易****失去方向感****。

2. After leaving university, he temporarily **lost his sense of direction**.

大學畢業後，他一度**失去了人生方向**。

38. sense of direction

= ability to know where you are and which way to go

方向感

Examples

1. She has an excellent **sense of direction**.

她的**方向感**很好。

2. I have a terrible **sense of direction**.

我的**方向感**很差。

Key contrasts

39. direction vs path

direction

= general orientation or course

方向

path

= actual route or course followed

道路；路徑

Compare:

> I know the general **direction**.

> 我知道大概的**方向**。

> I don't know which **path** to follow.

> 我不知道該走哪一條**路**。

In the passage:

* **path** = your personal life route

* **direction** = whether that development is heading somewhere constructive

40. direction vs route

****route****

= specific way from one location to another

****路線****

****direction****

= general orientation toward which movement occurs

****方向****

Compare:

> Which ****route**** should we take?

> 我們應該走哪條****路線****？

> Which ****direction**** is the station?

> 車站在哪個****方向****？

41. direction vs guidance

****direction****

can mean broad guidance about what to do or where to go.

****guidance****

= advice or help that assists someone in deciding or developing

****指導；引導****

Compare:

> The team needs clear ****direction****.

> 團隊需要清楚的方向與領導。

> Students need ****guidance**** when choosing courses.

> 學生選課時需要指導。

42. direction vs instruction

****direction****

can mean overall guidance.

****instruction****

usually gives a more specific command or explanation of what to do

****指示；說明****

Compare:

> She provided overall ****direction**** for the project.

> 她為專案提供整體方向。

> She gave detailed ****instructions**** for the task.

> 她對任務給了詳細指示。

43. directions vs instructions

directions

often:

* tell you how to get somewhere

* especially in American English, explain how to do something

instructions

more generally:

* explain exactly what to do

For learners:

> ****directions to the station**** = 到車站的路線指示

> ****instructions for the machine**** = 機器使用說明

44. direction vs trend

****trend****

= observable pattern of change over time

****趨勢****

****direction****

= general course in which that change is moving

****走向****

A trend can show the direction of change.

Meaning map

The central concept of **direction** is:

the course toward which something points or moves

From this develop several branches:

Physical orientation

which direction?

→ **方向**

Route guidance

directions to the station

→ **路線指示**

Development

career moving in a new direction

→ **發展方向**

Guidance

provide direction

→ **指導；引導**

Control

under someone's direction

→ **在某人領導下**

Instructions

follow the directions

→ **按照說明**

Creative work

film direction

→ **導演工作**

Trend

direction of change

→ **走向；趨勢**

The passage uses the figurative development branch:

physical movement has a direction

→ **personal growth also has a direction**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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direction — physical orientation	某人或某物移動、面向或指向的方位 / 方向
in the direction of...	朝著某個地方、位置或目標的方向
change direction	改變原本移動、面向或發展的方向
direction — route/course	某人或某事物前進的大致路線或走向
direction — development	某人、專案、組織或情況逐漸發展的方向 / 走向
the right direction	朝向較正確、合適、有益或理想結果的發展方向
the wrong direction	朝向不合適、錯誤或不理想結果的發展方向
direction — guidance	對應該如何前進、發展或行動所提供的引導 / 指導
provide direction	給予他人整體方向、重點或行動上的指引
under someone's direction	在某人的指導、領導或監督之下
directions — route instructions	告訴某人如何前往某地的路線指示
ask for directions	向別人詢問如何到達某地；問路
directions — instructions	告訴某人如何操作或完成某事的一連串說明
direction — management/control	對工作、專案或活動進行管理、監督或主導
direction — film/theatre	對電影、戲劇等作品中的表演與藝術呈現進行導演 / 指導
stage direction	劇本中告訴演員如何動作、說話或表演的舞台指示
direction — trend/course	某件事正在改變或發展的整體走向 / 趨勢
direction of research/discussion	研究、討論或思考所採取的主要焦點與發展方向
sense of direction	判斷自己位置以及該往哪裡走的能力；方向感
a step in the right direction	雖未完全解決問題，但已朝較好結果邁進的一步
point someone in the right direction	給某人足夠指引，使其知道應朝何處 / 如何繼續
direct — verb	指揮、引導或把某人 / 某物導向某處
direct — adjective	不經中間環節、直接到達或接觸的
director	負責主導組織、部門或藝術作品的人；主管 / 導演

| **redirect** | 把原來的方向、注意力、資料或行動重新導向別處 |

Passage recap

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a nudge in the right **direction**...”

Here:

direction = **the general course in which the speaker’s personal development was moving**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **正確的方向**

* **合適的發展方向**

* **更好的方向**

Natural contextual translation:

陳老師只是輕輕推了我一把，讓我朝著正確的方向前進。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

direction in **“the right direction”**

= **a course of development or action that leads toward a desirable result**

發展方向；行動方向；正確的走向

It is not merely a physical compass direction here. The metaphor is:

moving through space in a direction

→ **developing through life in a direction**.